

MishMash | BLEISTIFTSPANE

Everyone says that Thomas Mann's novel *The Magic Mountain* is about time. But we think it is about the discrediting of speech: the characters utter banalities, nonsense, play with words, and in the end Peeperkorn appears, whose speech consists of multivalent fragments, until at the climax of the waterfall it is entirely supplanted by the sound of water. The only sincere, deeply felt speech is between Hans Castorp and Clavdia Chauchat, when they explain themselves to one another — but both for that use a language not their own.

The book was written a hundred years ago, against the background of World War I, revolutions and civil wars.

And now, a hundred years later, we find ourselves again in a similar picture, and again it seems that speech has been discredited.

We propose a walk in which you yourself will assemble a book about *The Magic Mountain* using frottage and your own experience. Imagine that a **WHITE SHEET** is the **SNOW** from the chapter "Snowstorm," **FROTTAGE** is an **X-RAY** revealing the hidden, and the **PENCIL** is that very symbolic one from the chapter "Walpurgis Night." And perhaps we will start our journey through *The Magic Mountain* from the end — and move from war to ... well, we'll get there and see.

INSTRUCTION

I.

Print out this PDF.

II.

Put on a yellow raincoat.

Take a thick soft pencil
and go to Volkspark Friedrichshain.

III.

Follow the map and instructions, do frottages etc.

IV.

Send us photographs or scans of the results of your walk
for publication on the website.

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ABOUT SNOWY VOID

“The silence, when he stopped and stood motionless in order not to hear himself, was ultimate and unconditional — a soundlessness clad in wadding, unknown, unheard-of, impossible anywhere else. The little breeze would not touch the trees, nothing would stir; no bird would utter any voice. Into this primeval and speechless stillness Hans Castorp listened, when he stood like that, leaning on his stick, tilting his head on his shoulder, his mouth open. And snow kept falling in this mute silence, slowly, ceaselessly, and noiselessly settling upon the earth.”

“Wherever one looked, nothing was visible but isolated tiny snowflakes, which emerged from the white heights and softly lay on the white ground, and around them silence raged. While his gaze pressed itself into the white dazzling emptiness, he felt his own heartbeat, grown stronger from the climb — that muscular organ, whose animal aspect and how it trembles he perhaps had daringly glimpsed under the crack and flashes of lightning in the X-ray room — and suddenly he was seized by emotion, naive, reverent sympathy for his heart, for the beating human heart, so solitary here, among the icy void, with its question, with its mystery.”

ABOUT THE X-RAY

“...grabbing Hans Castorp by the hand, he dragged him to the rows of dark plates, behind which he switched on a lamp. They lit up at once, and images appeared on them. Hans Castorp saw all kinds of parts of the human body: arms, legs, kneecaps, shoulders, upper and lower parts of thighs and pelvis. But the living rounded forms of these parts of the body emerged only as vague ghostly outlines, only as a mist and pale glow surrounding the clearly, sharply and definitively emerging foundation — the skeleton.”

“... ‘You know,’ Settembrini answered reluctantly, ‘how I feel about such things. And you know that the spots and shadows within us most often have a purely physiological nature. I have seen hundreds of images much like yours, so the question of how much they attest to your individual personality is to some degree left to the judgment of the one who examines them.’”

ABOUT THE PENCIL

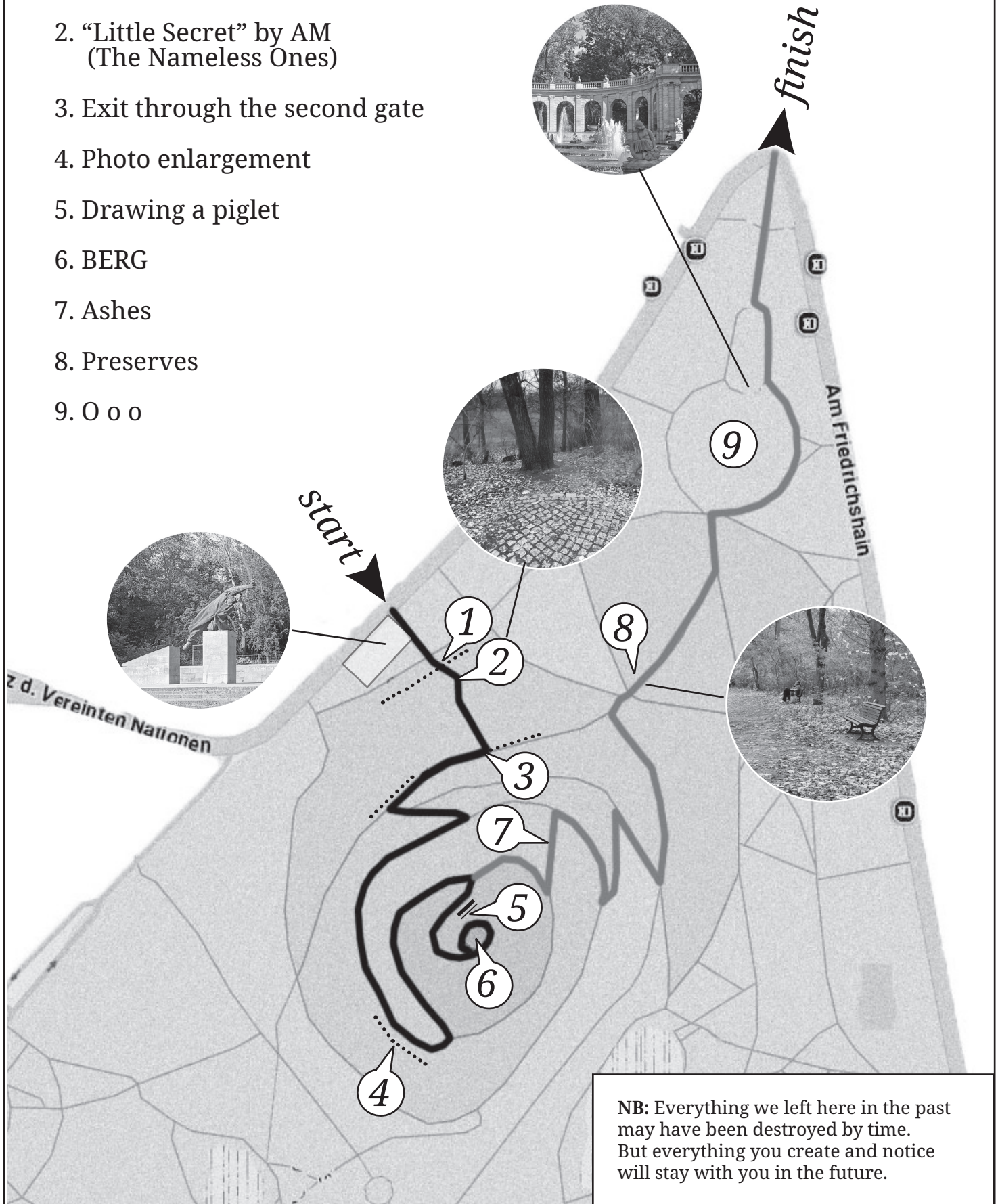
“But never in his life had Hans Castorp felt such pleasure as in that drawing class — for he was drawing with Przibyslaw Hippe’s pencil, and he was afterwards to return the pencil to its owner.”

“Pencil! Pencil! Who has a pencil?” he cried, turning now this way, now that; he still supported himself with his left hand on the ta-

ble, while with his right he shook something in the air. But he did not get a pencil. Then he turned and went to the far side of the room, continuing to demand a pencil — he went straight to Clavdia Chauchat, who, as he noticed, stood in the small drawing room near a curtain and from there smiled, watching the game at the table with punch.”

Volkspark Friedrichshain

1. Entrance through the gate
2. "Little Secret" by AM
(The Nameless Ones)
3. Exit through the second gate
4. Photo enlargement
5. Drawing a piglet
6. BERG
7. Ashes
8. Preserves
9. O o o



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“Oh, what a shame — this our safety of shadows! Away with it! We will not tell this! Has a shard pierced even our acquaintance? For a moment it seemed to him that yes. A huge clod of earth struck him on the shin; indeed, it hurt, but that was nonsense. He got up, limping, and stumbled further with legs

heavy from the earth, continuing to hum: And the branches rustled, Stirring in summons...

Thus, in the crush, under rain, in twilight, we lose sight of him.”

- ① Entrance to the gate. Turn around and behold the figure of the soldier.

“The scale of life was very small, the time from birth to death almost always did not exceed twenty years — youth almost everywhere — no mature people were found here,

the entire population was unstable; they had all come to this valley and permanently adopted a horizontal form of existence.”

- ② Turn slightly to the left and walk up the cobblestone hill. Under this tree, buried in the ground, lies a “little secret” from AM: The Nameless Ones. Find it. Then bury it again.



- ③ When we buried the secret, on our way to the next gate we found a stack of music scores pinned to a tree. It was a song from 1927 — **La montanara**, which means The Girl from the Mountains. Find it and listen to it before moving on. Then go through the gate onto the road leading up the mountain.

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“The breastbone, merging with the spinal column, formed a dark, as it were knotty column. Lines of the ribs, diverging from the sternum, intersected less distinct lines of the same ribs adjoining the spinal column. Above, the clavicles curved smoothly to both sides, and in the nebulous luminous envelope of bodily forms the skeleton of his shoulder and elbow bones appeared sharply and acutely. Inside the chest cavity it was light, but one could discern a network of blood vessels, some dark spots and blackish entangled threads.”

Press this paper sheet against a surface that strikes you,
hold it with your hand.

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"... 'even not small' is the same as 'monstrously great', and approach to the atom turned out, without exaggeration, to be truly fateful, for in the moment of the last division and fragmentation of a material particle the astronomical cosmos suddenly unfolded!"

Look down from the cliff, between trees #5835 and #5908.

- ④ Take your phone and make a blow-up photo.
Examine the result. Proceed upward.

"He tapped just under the collarbone, at the neck, above the chest and below, first on the right, then on the left. Having tapped, he proceeded to listen. Hans Castorp involuntarily recalled the scene at the tailor's: when a well-dressed gentleman takes measurements from another gentleman, in a strictly determined sequence applies the tape here and there to the customer's body, measuring chest girth, length of limbs, dictating the figures to his assistant stooped over the table. 'Short, shortened...' — the hofrat Berens dictated. 'Vesicular,' he noted, and then again: 'Vesicular' (this, evidently, was good). 'Rigid,' — he made a grimace — 'very rigid...' — wheezes. So, there is a dull sound there, and they produce it in places damaged earlier, where calcification has already occurred, they are, so to speak, scarred."

Find a stick; tap with it on an empty trunk, on an iron fence, on a stone.

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“... Leaning over the table and closing his eyes — but throwing back his head and wishing to show all that his eyes were indeed closed — he on the back of the calling card blindly drew with his pencil a picture: it was the outlines of a piglet, and his big hands drew it without using sight — in profile, though not very realistically, but rather in a simplified and schematic way; yet the spectators clearly saw the piglet’s outline. The narrow eye was where it should have been, though a bit nearer the snout than proper; similarly the small ear on the head, and the legs protruding from the round belly; and as continuation of the rounded line

of the back a neat little curl of tail. When the drawing was finished, all cried ‘Ah!’ — and began vying to approach the table, overcome by ambition to emulate the master. Yet even with open eyes only a few could draw a piglet, much less with closed eyes. And what monstrosities appeared! There was no connection between body parts. The eye turned out somewhere outside the piglet, the legs inside the belly, which was not closed, the tail curled to the side without any connection to the main outline, like some independent arabesque. They laughed themselves sick. New patients approached.”

- ⑤ Find in a crevice of the wall a little box;
inside it there will be a card and a pencil.
Close your eyes and draw a piglet over the piglet.
Now hide everything back for the next patients.



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*“The mountain opposite, with its stubble of
firs on the ridge, was plainly visible and re-
posed in peace. The shadow enveloped only
its lower half, while the upper was bathed in
the softest pink light. What had happened,
what was being wrought in the world?”*

*“... in the note stood:
But remember!
The mountain today is full of magic,
And if with a little flame she beckons you,
Do not blindly trust her.”*

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- ⑥ Strangely, in the whole book the word MOUNTAIN appears only three times (one in the title). Watch the parapet on the mountain’s summit — here you will find the word BERG thrice, which you can frottage.
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“First he threw both blankets to the left, tucked them under him up to his armpits, then folded them at the feet and threw them to the right; now he was a smooth, even bundle from which only his head, shoulders, and arms stuck out. ‘You do this well,’ said Hans Castorp.”

“The destruction of a corpse by fire — what a neat, hygienic, dignified, even heroic prospect compared with inglorious decomposition and assimilation by lower organisms! And our feelings somehow more easily

reconcile with this new method, more fitting to man’s need for immortality. For fire consumes exactly the mutable, metabolically active parts of the body; those which are least involved in the common cycle and change little with age are most fire-resistant — from them comes the ash, thus with ash relatives and friends preserve what in the deceased was truly enduring. ‘Marvelous!’ said Naphta. ‘No, it is indeed very, very sweet. The enduring in man is the ash.’”

7

We have left cozy bundles of earth and ash here.
Do you see them? What is their state?



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“... As if someone arranged for mockery that with the coming of winter it is, in effect, spring, and with the coming of summer — autumn...”

“... eternity is not ‘straight ahead, ahead,’ but ‘around, around,’ a true merry-go-round.”

“This, of course, is not alchemy or purification, simply preservation, conservation — hence the name ‘canned goods.’ The magic here lay in the fact that the products in the jars had been extracted from time, hermetically separated from it, time passed by them unobserved, for them it did not exist.”

⑧

On the backs of these benches we left a few photographs for you — a preserved summer.



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“Around the bend in the road travelers came upon a forested rocky gorge and a bridge over it, and a waterfall plunged into this gorge; when it became visible it had reached its full force and its roar <...> They explained by glances and signs, for their voices, even if they shouted into each other’s ear; would have been drowned by the thunder of the waterfall. In vain their lips uttered words of amazement and delight; those words remained voiceless. <...> Raising his coat collar and placing his hat beside him, Peeperkorn <...> began to speak. A remarkable man! It was impossible to as-

sume he heard his own voice, and the others certainly caught not a single word of what he proclaimed, though he could not render it public. Still, he raised the index finger of his right hand, in which he held a glass, and stretched out his left a bit sideways, palm open; everyone saw how his kingly face moved, how his lips formed words which remained mute, as though he spoke in vacuum. <...> From his face and lip movements one could guess the words those present were accustomed to hear from him: ‘Excellent,’ ‘Concluded.’”

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- ⑨ Finally find and frottage on the fountain surfaces as many “O” letters as possible.
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